

# THE RISE OF THE STY

**With every function turned into a flashbulb appearance and red carpet event, Bollywood stars are turning to an army of professionals to dodge an increasingly watchful fashion police**

■ By Kaveree Bamzai

**F**renzied fittings half an hour before the ramp show, panic calls at 4 in the morning, hush-hush meetings in hotel rooms and last-minute change of dress plans. With flashbulbs popping and laptops firing fashion missiles, the world of celebrity glamour just got more glittering. From designing costumes for films to getting stars to model in fashion week, celebrity stylists are spotting trends, following fads and sometimes, just concealing flaws.

As stars struggle to keep up with their glamorous onscreen images, a fashion victim is born every minute. From empire waists for the elephantine-waisted to bubble dresses for those with badly scraped knees, Bollywood women find themselves under scrutiny. As do the men. The what-do-I-wear cry is no longer the prerogative of the woman. The Bollywood man is equally at home calling up the designer *du jour* to ask for the perfect suit, the finest white shirt, or just plain sane advice on what knot to wear on what tie.

At the other end is the stylist, dispensing advice on hair length as easily as he or she stitches up the perfect pink dress. In the age of the 24x7 red carpet walk, the stylist's work is never done. So Hrithik Roshan can give Anaita Shroff Adajania just a day to get a jacket tailored for the MTV Awards, with instructions on what jeans, shoes and T-shirt to wear it with. Bipasha Basu can tell Gauri and Nainika Karan to carry a gown for her to Jodhpur for the *Vogue India* launch. And Saif Ali Khan can give Narendra Kumar Ahmed four hours to send him a suit for *Saawariya*'s high glam Mumbai premiere, then listen to him and team it with a pair of jeans.

India is still a long way from the Rachel Zoe-isation of style, where one



**GAURI AND NAINIKA KARAN** Be it Bipasha Basu's blue and white dress (right) or Aishwarya Rai's (above) promotional appearances, the stars have discovered the sisters' classic Hollywood glamour.

